Healing Plates

THE 30-DAY ALLERGY-FREE FAMILY MEAL PLAN

Breakfast, lunch & dinner free from gluten, dairy, corn, egg, caffeine & tuna



90 family meals

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free

Finally... food the whole family can eat.

BY

Tris Eliverson

WELCOME

You are not alone



Dear Mama, dear Papa,

If you are holding this book, I already know a little of your story — because it is my story too. **I am an autism mum.** I know the child who eats only three foods. The nights that don't end. The family members who say “just give him bread, he'll be fine.” The quiet ache when the words haven't come yet.

When I changed what went on my child's plate — taking out gluten, dairy, corn and eggs, cooking real food from scratch, and adding a gentle detox drink each day — things began to change. Slowly at first. Then I saw a **real, significant improvement** in my child. I could not keep these recipes to myself.

This book holds the meals, drinks and routines that helped my family. No long science. No fancy ingredients you can't find. Just real food from our homes — yam, plantain, okro, rice and beans — made safe, one day at a time.

Every child is different, and food is not a replacement for your doctor. But it is a beautiful place to start — and you don't have to start alone.

You don't have to be perfect. You just have to begin. ♥

With love, Tris Eliverson

AUTISM MUM · RECIPE CREATOR

KNOW BEFORE YOU SHOP

Where allergens hide

Many “safe-looking” foods hide gluten, dairy, corn or caffeine. Here is where they hide — especially in our African kitchens.

Avoid	Where it hides
Gluten	Bread, semovita, wheat swallow, chin chin, puff-puff, meat pie, pasta, **Milo, Bournvita & Ovaltine** (barley malt), soy sauce, many stock cubes
Dairy	Peak/Three Crowns milk, butter, cheese, yogurt, ice cream, whey, casein, “non-dairy” creamers that contain casein
Corn	**Pap/ogi/akamu**, kenkey, banku, tuwo masara, ugali, pap (SA), custard powder, cornflour, popcorn, **baking powder** (corn starch), glucose syrup, xanthan gum, many gluten-free flour blends
Egg	Cakes, mayonnaise, some pasta, egg rolls, meat pies, many “gluten-free” breads and pancake mixes
Caffeine	Tea (black & green), coffee, matcha, cola, energy drinks, **kola nut**, chocolate & cocoa, Milo
Tuna	Canned tuna, tuna salad, some sandwiches, sushi and fish pies
Pork	Bacon, ham, sausages, lard, gelatine (sweets & jelly), some suya

The 10-second label rule

Turn the pack over. Read the ingredients **every time** — brands change their recipes. If you can't pronounce it, or it says “may contain”, leave it on the shelf.

5 steps to healing the gut

When the gut is out of balance, everything feels harder — sleep, moods, toilet troubles and picky eating. These 5 steps are the heart of this book.

1 Remove the irritants

Dairy, gluten, fried food, cookies, bread, processed food, refined sugar, corn, pap and garri.
Swap: dairy → coconut; flour → tapioca, potato or buckwheat flour.

2 Support digestion with healing nutrients

Zinc and magnesium from leafy vegetables and pumpkin seeds.

3 Repair the gut

Keep the gut hydrated and nourished: berries, psyllium husk, okro stew, egusi soup (no tripe or intestine).

4 Knock down the bad bugs

Garlic, onions, rosemary, thyme, potatoes, carrots, courgette, pumpkin, coconut yogurt, green banana and gluten-free oats.

5 Rebuild & protect — keep the good going

Feed the good bacteria every day: green banana, plantain, onions, garlic, beans and gluten-free oats, plus a spoon of coconut yogurt. Eat at regular times, drink water, sleep well and keep moving. Bring foods back **one at a time**, and keep a simple food & mood diary so you can see what helps. Ask your doctor whether a probiotic is right for your child.

Picky eating is not bad behaviour

A child who eats only three foods is often a child whose nervous system feels unsafe. Go gently. One new food at a time, next to a food they already love.

MAKE ONCE, USE ALL MONTH

Kitchen basics

BASIC Flax "Egg" (replaces 1 egg)

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
- [ ] 3 tbsp water

STEPS

1. Stir the flaxseed and water together.
2. Leave for 5 minutes until thick, like egg white.
3. Use in pancakes, muffins and meatballs in place of 1 egg.

Why it helps: Binds food just like egg, and adds fibre and omega-3.

BASIC Healing Seasoning Mix (replaces stock cubes)

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 tbsp onion powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp garlic powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp dried thyme
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish (optional)
- [ ] 1 tsp ground ginger
- [ ] 1 tsp white pepper
- [ ] 1 tsp pure curry powder
- [ ] 1 tbsp sea salt

STEPS

1. Mix everything in a clean, dry jar.
2. Use 1–2 tsp wherever a recipe says "seasoning".
3. Keeps for 2 months with the lid tight.

Why it helps: Many stock cubes hide wheat, corn starch and MSG. This one is pure flavour.

BASIC Soft Cassava Flatbread (wraps, pizza & pinwheels)

20 min · makes 6

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup (130 g) cassava flour
- [ ] ¾ cup warm water
- [ ] 2 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] ½ tsp salt

STEPS

1. Mix everything into a soft dough. Rest 5 min.
2. Divide into 6 balls (or 2 for pizza bases).
3. Press thin between two sheets of parchment paper.
4. Cook in a dry hot pan 1–2 min each side until spotty.
5. Stack under a clean towel to stay soft.

Why it helps: A gluten-free, corn-free, egg-free wrap you can trust.

BASIC

Crunchy Nut-Free Granola

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] ½ cup pumpkin seeds
- [ ] ½ cup sunflower seeds
- [ ] ¼ cup coconut flakes
- [ ] 3 tbsp melted coconut oil
- [ ] 3 tbsp maple syrup or honey
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 160 °C / 320 °F. Line a tray with parchment.
2. Mix everything and spread thin.
3. Bake 20 min, stirring halfway.
4. Cool completely — it crisps as it cools. Store in a jar.

Why it helps: Seeds give zinc and magnesium — step 2 of healing the gut.

YOUR WEEK AT A GLANCE

Week 1

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
B Banana buckwheat pancakes	B Yam & ugu sauce	B Mango overnight oats	B Millet porridge	B Sweet potato hash	B Ripe plantain pancakes	B Coconut yogurt parfait
L Okro soup & pounded yam	L Chicken burrito bowl	L Jollof rice & chicken	L Butternut mac & cheese	L Thai coconut noodle soup	L Kenyan beef pilau	L Sunday roast chicken
D Lentil spaghetti bolognese	D Coriander pepper fish	D Chicken nuggets & wedges	D Egusi soup & amala	D Egg-free moi moi	D Family pizza night	D Green plantain porridge

TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 1 shopping list

Everything for Days 1–7. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Ugu or spinach — 4 big bunches
- [ ] Okro — 15
- [ ] Tomatoes — 16
- [ ] Red peppers — 6
- [ ] Scotch bonnet / ata rodo — 5
- [ ] Onions — 10, red onion — 1
- [ ] Garlic — 2 bulbs, ginger — 1 large piece
- [ ] Carrots — 6
- [ ] Courgette — 1
- [ ] Butternut squash — 1
- [ ] Broccoli — 2 heads
- [ ] Sweet potatoes — 8
- [ ] Potatoes — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Cucumber — 3
- [ ] Mushrooms — 200 g
- [ ] Lemongrass — 1 stalk
- [ ] Avocados — 5
- [ ] Frozen peas — 1 bag

Fruit & plantain

- [ ] Yam — 1 medium
- [ ] Green plantains — 7
- [ ] Very ripe plantains — 2
- [ ] Ripe bananas — 2
- [ ] Mangoes — 2
- [ ] Mixed berries — 3 punnets
- [ ] Lemons — 3, limes — 4

Protein

- [ ] Chicken pieces — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Chicken thighs — 1.1 kg
- [ ] Chicken breast — 600 g
- [ ] Whole chicken — 1.5 kg
- [ ] Beef mince — 500 g
- [ ] Beef cubes — 1.1 kg
- [ ] Turkey mince — 250 g
- [ ] Mackerel or tilapia — 4 small
- [ ] Smoked mackerel — 1
- [ ] Black-eyed beans — 2 cups
- [ ] Black beans — 1 tin

Grains & flours

- [ ] Lentil pasta — 2 × 400 g
- [ ] Long-grain rice + basmati — 3 cups each
- [ ] Rice noodles — 200 g
- [ ] Buckwheat flour
- [ ] Cassava flour
- [ ] Pure millet flour
- [ ] Certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] Amala & pounded yam flour
- [ ] Ground egusi — 1 cup

Dairy-free & pantry

- [ ] Coconut milk — 5 tins
- [ ] Coconut yogurt — 1 large tub
- [ ] Dairy-free cheese — 1 pack
- [ ] Chopped tomatoes — 2 tins, passata — 1 jar, tomato paste
- [ ] Red palm, olive, avocado & coconut oil
- [ ] Chia seeds, ground flaxseed
- [ ] Pumpkin & sunflower seeds, coconut flakes
- [ ] Coconut aminos
- [ ] Maple syrup or raw honey, dates
- [ ] Baking soda, tapioca flour

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh coriander — 2 bunches
- [ ] Fresh rosemary & thyme
- [ ] Dried thyme, oregano, basil, bay leaves
- [ ] Pure curry powder, paprika, cumin, turmeric
- [ ] Cinnamon, cloves, cardamom, black pepper
- [ ] Garlic & onion powder, ground ginger
- [ ] Ground crayfish
- [ ] Sea salt

WEEK 1

Day 1

"Small changes, one plate at a time. You are doing better than you think."

BREAKFAST — Fluffy Banana Buckwheat Pancakes

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup buckwheat flour
- [ ] 1 ripe banana, mashed
- [ ] 1 flax egg (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda + 1 tsp lemon juice
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon, pinch of salt
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the pan

STEPS

1. Mix the banana, flax egg and coconut milk.
2. Stir in the flour, cinnamon, salt and baking soda, then the lemon juice.
3. Heat a little oil in a pan on medium-low.
4. Cook small pancakes 2 min until bubbles appear, flip, 1 more min.
5. Top with berries and a drizzle of maple syrup.

Why it helps: Buckwheat is naturally gluten-free and full of magnesium.

Good to know: Baking soda + lemon makes pancakes rise without corn-starch baking powder.

LUNCH — Okro Soup with Chicken & Pounded Yam

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken pieces
- [ ] 15 fresh okro, chopped
- [ ] 1 cup ugu or spinach
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 ata rodo peppers
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] Pounded yam or amala, to serve

STEPS

1. Season chicken with onion and seasoning. Cook in 2 cups water for 20 min.
2. Add palm oil, pepper and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
3. Add okro and cook only 3–4 min so it stays green.
4. Stir in the greens and turn off the heat.
5. Serve with pounded yam.

Why it helps: Okro is soft and gentle on the gut and helps keep things moving.

Kid tip: Picky eater? Blend the okro smooth so there are no "slimy bits" to see.

DINNER — Hidden-Veggie Lentil Spaghetti Bolognese

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g red lentil pasta
- [ ] 500 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 carrot + 1 courgette, finely grated
- [ ] 2 tins chopped tomatoes
- [ ] 1 tsp dried oregano, 1 tsp basil
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil, salt

STEPS

1. Soften onion and garlic in olive oil, 3 min.
2. Add the mince and brown it, breaking it up.
3. Stir in the grated carrot and courgette — they disappear into the sauce.
4. Add tomatoes and herbs. Simmer 20 min.
5. Cook the pasta as the pack says and serve with the sauce.

Why it helps: Lentil pasta is high in protein and fibre — one of the speech-support foods in this book.

Kid tip: Blend the sauce smooth for children who don't like "bits".

WEEK 1

Day 2

Today's habit: 10 minutes of bouncing or dancing — it gets the lymph system moving.

BREAKFAST Boiled Yam with Ugu & Tomato Sauce

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] ½ medium yam, peeled & sliced
- [ ] 2 cups ugu (or spinach), chopped
- [ ] 3 fresh tomatoes, chopped
- [ ] 1 onion, sliced
- [ ] 2 tbsp unrefined red palm oil
- [ ] ¼ tsp ground crayfish (optional)
- [ ] Pinch of salt

STEPS

1. Boil the yam in salted water for 15–20 min until soft.
2. Warm the palm oil gently — don't let it smoke. Add onion, cook 2 min.
3. Add tomatoes and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
4. Stir in the ugu, cook 2 min, then turn off the heat.
5. Spoon the sauce over the yam.

Why it helps: Yam gives slow, steady energy. Ugu is rich in iron and magnesium.

Swap it: No yam? Use sweet potato. No ugu? Use spinach, kale or sukuma wiki.

LUNCH Chicken Burrito Bowl

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups rice
- [ ] 600 g chicken thighs
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin & paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder
- [ ] 1 tin black beans, rinsed
- [ ] 2 avocados, sliced
- [ ] 3 tomatoes + ½ red onion + coriander (salsa)
- [ ] 2 limes, olive oil, salt

STEPS

1. Cook the rice.
2. Rub chicken with the spices, oil and salt. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 25 min, then slice.
3. Warm the beans with a pinch of salt.
4. Chop tomatoes, onion and coriander with lime juice for salsa.
5. Build bowls: rice, beans, chicken, avocado, salsa.

Why it helps: Beans and avocado bring fibre and healthy fats that keep little tummies full.

Allergy note: Shop-bought bowls usually add corn — this one leaves it out.

DINNER Coriander Pepper Fish & Green Plantain

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 small mackerel (titus) or tilapia
- [ ] 3 green (unripe) plantains
- [ ] 1 handful fresh coriander
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves, 1 small onion
- [ ] 1 scotch bonnet (skip for kids)
- [ ] 1 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1 lemon, salt

STEPS

1. Blend coriander, garlic, onion, pepper, oil, lemon and salt to a paste.
2. Rub the paste over the fish. Rest 15 min.
3. Bake on parchment at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20–25 min (no foil).
4. Meanwhile, peel and boil the plantains for 20 min.
5. Serve with sliced cucumber.

Why it helps: Small fish carry far less mercury than tuna. Coriander is a traditional cleansing herb.

WEEK 1

Day 3

"Healing is not a straight line. Celebrate every small win."

BREAKFAST Mango Chia Overnight Oats

5 min + overnight

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups certified gluten-free oats
- [ ] 2 cups coconut milk
- [ ] 2 tbsp chia seeds
- [ ] 1 mango, diced
- [ ] 1 tsp cinnamon
- [ ] 1 tbsp maple syrup (optional)

STEPS

1. Stir oats, coconut milk, chia, cinnamon and maple together.
2. Spoon into 4 jars or cups.
3. Cover and chill overnight.
4. In the morning, top with mango and eat cold.

Why it helps: Chia and oats are gentle fibre for regular, easy bowels.

Swap it: Can't have oats? Use millet or buckwheat flakes instead.

LUNCH Jollof Rice with Baked Chicken

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups long-grain parboiled rice
- [ ] 1 kg chicken pieces
- [ ] 6 tomatoes, 3 red peppers, 1 onion, 1 scotch bonnet
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato paste, 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 1 tsp thyme, 1 tsp pure curry powder, 2 bay leaves
- [ ] 2 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] 3 cups chicken stock or water

STEPS

1. Season chicken and bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 40 min.
2. Blend tomatoes, peppers, onion and scotch bonnet.
3. Fry tomato paste in oil 3 min, add the blend and cook 15 min until thick.
4. Add spices, stock and rinsed rice. Cover tightly and cook on low 25–30 min.
5. Fluff and serve with the chicken and a fresh salad.

Why it helps: A home favourite made without stock cubes — all flavour, no hidden wheat or MSG.

DINNER Crispy Baked Chicken Nuggets & Sweet Potato Wedges

35 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 600 g chicken breast, cut into bite pieces
- [ ] 1 cup cassava flour
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] 3 tbsp olive oil
- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes, cut into wedges
- [ ] Frozen peas, to serve

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F. Line 2 trays with parchment.
2. Toss the wedges with 1 tbsp oil and salt. Bake 30 min.
3. Toss chicken in the remaining oil, then roll in flour mixed with the spices.
4. Bake the nuggets 15–18 min, turning once, until golden.
5. Serve with peas and Sunshine Ketchup (Lunch Box book).

Why it helps: All the fun of fast food — with no egg, no wheat crumb and no deep frying.

Picky eater trick: Let them dip! Children try more food when they can dip it.

WEEK 1

Day 4

Today's habit: eat breakfast near a sunny window or outside — morning light helps sleep later.

BREAKFAST Creamy Millet Porridge (Hausa Koko Style)

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup pure millet flour (no corn added)
- [ ] 4 cups water
- [ ] 1 thumb ginger, grated
- [ ] Pinch of cloves
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 3 dates, chopped (to sweeten)

STEPS

1. Mix the millet flour with 1 cup cold water until smooth.
2. Boil the rest of the water with ginger, cloves and dates.
3. Pour in the millet mix, stirring all the time.
4. Cook 8–10 min on low until thick. Stir in coconut milk.

Why it helps: Millet is a gluten-free ancient grain that is gentle on the stomach.

Allergy note: Many "koko" and "uji" mixes contain maize — buy pure millet flour.

LUNCH Creamy Butternut "Mac & Cheese"

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 400 g lentil or chickpea pasta
- [ ] 3 cups butternut squash, cubed
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] 3 tbsp nutritional yeast (optional — cheesy taste)
- [ ] 1 garlic clove, ½ tsp turmeric, salt
- [ ] 1 cup small broccoli florets

STEPS

1. Boil the squash and garlic 12 min until soft. Drain.
2. Blend with coconut milk, nutritional yeast, turmeric and salt.
3. Cook the pasta, adding the broccoli for the last 3 minutes.
4. Stir the golden sauce through the pasta.

Why it helps: Squash is a root-vegetable carb from the author's "foods to eat" list — and kids love the colour.

Leftover magic: Bake leftovers in a muffin tin for 15 min to make mac bites for lunch boxes.

DINNER Egusi Soup with Beef & Amala

50 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup ground egusi
- [ ] 500 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion + 2 red peppers + 1 scotch bonnet, blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp ground crayfish
- [ ] 2 cups ugu or spinach
- [ ] Amala (yam flour), to serve

STEPS

1. Cook beef with onion and seasoning mix until tender, 30 min. Keep the stock.
2. Mix egusi with a little water to a thick paste.
3. Warm palm oil, add the pepper blend and cook 5 min. Add egusi in lumps and cook 10 min.
4. Add beef, stock and crayfish. Simmer 10 min.
5. Stir in the greens. Serve with amala.

Why it helps: Egusi (melon seeds) is a gut-repairing food from step 3 — rich in protein and zinc.

WEEK 1

Day 5

"You are not behind. You are exactly where your family needs you to be."

BREAKFAST — Sweet Potato & Spinach Breakfast Hash

25 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 sweet potatoes, diced small
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 onion, diced
- [ ] 250 g turkey mince (or 1 tin beans)
- [ ] 2 handfuls spinach
- [ ] 1 tsp paprika, salt
- [ ] 2 tbsp avocado oil
- [ ] 1 avocado, to serve

STEPS

1. Cook sweet potato in oil, covered, 10 min, stirring now and then.
2. Add onion, pepper and turkey. Cook 8 min.
3. Add paprika, salt and spinach. Stir until wilted.
4. Serve topped with sliced avocado.

Why it helps: A savoury, protein-rich breakfast that keeps energy steady until lunch.

LUNCH — Thai Coconut Chicken Noodle Soup

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 500 g chicken thighs, thinly sliced
- [ ] 1 tin coconut milk + 3 cups stock
- [ ] 1 stalk lemongrass, bashed
- [ ] 1 thumb ginger, 2 garlic cloves, sliced
- [ ] 1 tbsp coconut aminos (instead of soy sauce)
- [ ] 200 g rice noodles
- [ ] Lime, fresh coriander

STEPS

1. Simmer stock, lemongrass, ginger and garlic 5 min.
2. Add chicken and cook 8 min.
3. Pour in coconut milk and coconut aminos. Heat gently.
4. Cook the noodles, divide into bowls and ladle soup over.
5. Finish with lime and coriander.

Why it helps: Warm, mild and soothing — garlic and ginger support step 4 of healing the gut.

Allergy note: Soy sauce contains wheat. Coconut aminos tastes similar and is safe.

DINNER — Egg-Free Moi Moi with Avocado Salad

1 hr 15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups black-eyed beans, soaked & peeled
- [ ] 1 red pepper, 1 scotch bonnet, 1 onion
- [ ] 3 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix, salt
- [ ] About 1 cup warm water
- [ ] Avocado, tomato & cucumber salad

STEPS

1. Blend beans, pepper and onion with water until very smooth.
2. Stir in oil, crayfish, seasoning and salt.
3. Pour into greased ramekins or silicone cups (no foil).
4. Steam 45–50 min until firm.
5. Serve with the salad.

Why it helps: Beans set perfectly on their own — no egg needed. Packed with plant protein.

WEEK 1

Day 6

It's Friday — Sweet Treat Day! See the sweet treats page.

BREAKFAST Ripe Plantain Pancakes

20 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 very ripe (black) plantains
- [ ] ½ cup cassava flour
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] ½ cup coconut milk
- [ ] ½ tsp cinnamon, pinch salt
- [ ] ½ tsp baking soda + squeeze of lemon
- [ ] Coconut oil, for the pan

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Heat a little oil in a pan on medium-low.
3. Cook small pancakes 2–3 min each side.
4. Serve with berries or coconut yogurt.

Why it helps: Naturally sweet from the plantain — no sugar needed.

LUNCH Kenyan Beef Pilau & Kachumbari

1 hr

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 cups basmati rice
- [ ] 600 g beef, cubed
- [ ] 2 onions, 4 garlic cloves, 1 thumb ginger
- [ ] 2 potatoes, cubed
- [ ] 1 tsp each cumin, cinnamon, cardamom, black pepper; 4 cloves
- [ ] 2 tomatoes, salt
- [ ] Kachumbari: tomato, red onion, cucumber, coriander, lime

STEPS

1. Boil beef with salt until tender, 30 min. Keep 5 cups of stock.
2. Brown onions in oil, add garlic, ginger and spices, 2 min.
3. Add beef, potatoes, tomatoes and rinsed rice; stir.
4. Pour in stock, cover and cook on low 20 min.
5. Serve with the fresh chopped kachumbari.

Why it helps: Warm spices like cinnamon and ginger are gentle on digestion.

DINNER Family Pizza Night

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cassava flatbread pizza bases (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 cup tomato passata
- [ ] 1 tsp oregano
- [ ] 1 cup dairy-free cheese, grated
- [ ] Cooked chicken, peppers, mushrooms
- [ ] Olive oil

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 220 °C / 425 °F.
2. Spread passata over the bases, sprinkle oregano.
3. Add cheese and toppings.
4. Bake 10–12 min until bubbling.
5. Slice and serve with a green salad.

Why it helps: Pizza night is back on the menu — no gluten, dairy or corn.

Picky eater trick: Let each child top their own slice. Kids eat what they make.

WEEK 1

Day 7

Sunday: batch-cook day. See next week's plan and prep ahead.

BREAKFAST Coconut Yogurt Berry Parfait

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups coconut yogurt
- [ ] 2 cups mixed berries
- [ ] 1 cup Crunchy Nut-Free Granola (see Basics)
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey or maple syrup (optional)

STEPS

1. Layer yogurt, berries and granola in glasses.
2. Repeat the layers.
3. Drizzle with honey and eat straight away.

Why it helps: Coconut yogurt feeds good gut bacteria — step 4 of healing the gut.

LUNCH Sunday Roast Chicken & Vegetables

1 hr 30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 whole chicken (1.5 kg)
- [ ] 1 kg potatoes, halved
- [ ] 4 carrots, 2 sweet potatoes
- [ ] 1 lemon, 1 garlic bulb
- [ ] Fresh rosemary & thyme
- [ ] 3 tbsp avocado oil, salt
- [ ] 1 tbsp tapioca flour (for gravy)

STEPS

1. Rub chicken with oil, salt and herbs; put lemon and garlic inside. Roast at 190 °C / 375 °F for 1 hr 20 min.
2. Boil potatoes 8 min, drain, toss in oil and roast 45 min with the carrots.
3. Rest the chicken 10 min.
4. Stir pan juices with tapioca mixed in a little water until thick — gravy!
5. Serve with steamed broccoli.

Why it helps: Rosemary, thyme and garlic are all on the author's gut-friendly list.

Allergy note: Gravy granules often contain wheat and corn starch. Tapioca makes a safe gravy.

DINNER Green Plantain Porridge

40 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 4 green (unripe) plantains, cubed
- [ ] 2 tbsp red palm oil
- [ ] 1 onion + 2 tomatoes + 1 pepper, blended
- [ ] 1 tbsp crayfish, 1 tsp seasoning mix
- [ ] 1 small smoked mackerel, flaked (not tuna)
- [ ] 1 cup ugu or spinach

STEPS

1. Warm the oil, add the blend and cook 5 min.
2. Add plantain, crayfish, seasoning and water to just cover.
3. Cook 20 min until soft. Mash a little to thicken.
4. Stir in the fish and greens. Cook 3 min.

Why it helps: Green plantain is full of resistant starch that feeds good gut bacteria.

SWEET TREAT

Coconut Mango Ice Pops

No refined sugar
10 min + freezing

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 ripe mangoes, peeled & chopped
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk
- [ ] Juice of ½ lime
- [ ] 1 tbsp honey (optional — not for babies under 1)

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Pour into ice-pop moulds or small cups.
3. Freeze for 6 hours or overnight.
4. Run the mould under warm water for 10 seconds to pop out.

Why it helps: A sweet, cold treat with no dairy, no refined sugar and a big dose of vitamin C.

Sweet moment: Let your child pour the mix into the moulds — helping makes them want to taste.

SWEET TREAT

Banana Blueberry "Nice-Cream"

No refined sugar
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 3 ripe bananas, sliced and frozen
- [ ] 3 tbsp coconut milk
- [ ] Handful of blueberries
- [ ] Sprinkle of pumpkin seeds (optional)

STEPS

1. Blend the frozen banana and coconut milk until thick and creamy.
2. Add the blueberries and pulse a few times for purple swirls.
3. Scoop into bowls and top with pumpkin seeds. Eat straight away.

Why it helps: Tastes like ice cream, but it's just fruit. Blueberries are rich in antioxidants.

Sweet moment: Freeze sliced bananas every time they get spotty — instant dessert, no waste.

Every Friday is Sweet Treat Day — because healing food should still feel like a celebration.

BONUS: CELEBRATIONS

A real birthday cake

Every child deserves to blow out candles on a cake they can actually eat.

BIRTHDAY

Celebration Vanilla Berry Cake

1 hr + cooling · one 20 cm / 8 in cake

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup (140 g) brown rice flour
- [ ] ½ cup (60 g) tapioca flour + ½ cup (80 g) potato starch
- [ ] 1 tsp psyllium husk powder
- [ ] ¾ cup coconut sugar
- [ ] 1 tsp baking soda, ¼ tsp salt
- [ ] 1 cup coconut milk or water
- [ ] ⅓ cup light olive or avocado oil
- [ ] 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar + 1 tsp pure vanilla powder

STEPS

1. Heat oven to 180 °C / 350 °F. Line a round tin with parchment.
2. Whisk all the dry ingredients together.
3. Add the milk, oil, vinegar and vanilla. Mix just until smooth.
4. Bake 30–35 min until a skewer comes out clean. Cool completely.
5. Frost with chilled whipped coconut cream + 1 tbsp maple syrup. Top with berries and candles!

Why it helps: No egg, dairy, gluten, corn or nuts — every child at the party can have a slice.

Allergy note: Many vanilla extracts use corn alcohol. Pure vanilla powder or seeds are safe.

BONUS: CELEBRATIONS

Party survival guide

Parties, owambes, church events and school trips can feel scary. With a little planning, your child can join in — and feel included.

Before the party

- Message the host early. Share the allergy card from the Printables pack.
- Ask what will be served — then offer to bring one safe dish to share.
- Feed your child a proper meal first, so they're never hungry and tempted.

Pack a "party box"

- A slice of the Celebration Cake, frozen ahead in portions.
- Nuggets, plantain chips, fruit kebabs, a juice from Healing Sips.
- Make it look special — a bright box, a sticker, a party napkin.

At the party

- Stay close to the food table for younger children.
- Teach a simple line: "No thank you, I have my own special snack."
- Watch for shared bowls of sweets, chin chin and puff-puff.

Eating out

- Choose grilled chicken or fish, plain rice, boiled potatoes, salad.
- Ask: "Is there wheat, milk, butter, egg or corn starch in this?"
- Avoid sauces, gravies, batters and anything deep-fried in shared oil.

Sensory overwhelm is real

Loud music and crowds can be a lot. Arrive early when it's quiet, find a calm corner, and plan a gentle exit time. Leaving happy is a win.

MAKE SHOPPING EASIER

Allergy-friendly brands near you

Always read the label — brands can change their recipes. Many gluten-free products still contain corn or egg.

Nigeria

Swallows: Ola-Ola & Iyan Ado pounded yam flour, plantain flour

Rice: Ofada, Mama Gold, Royal Stallion

Dairy-free: Kara or Chaokoh coconut milk, homemade tigernut milk (kunu aya)

Oils: Figaro extra virgin olive oil, unrefined red palm oil

Shops: Spar, Prince Ebeano, Justrite, Grand Square, local markets

Ghana

Swallows: Pure cassava or plantain fufu flour (no corn), yam flour

Dairy-free: Coconut milk, homemade tigernut milk

Drinks: Sobolo (no sugar), ginger, coconut water

Shops: Melcom, MaxMart, Shoprite, Makola market

Kenya

Flours: Pure wimbi (finger millet) or sorghum flour — check no maize is added

Dairy-free: Kara coconut milk, coconut cream

Drinks: Ginger-lemongrass “chai” without tea leaves

Shops: Naivas, Quickmart, Carrefour, Chandarana

South Africa

Dairy-free: Oh Mylk, Alpro, Rhodes coconut milk

Drinks: Freshpak Rooibos (naturally caffeine-free)

Pantry: Nature's Choice, Bob's Red Mill gluten-free

Shops: Woolworths, Checkers, Dis-Chem, Faithful to Nature

United Kingdom

Dairy-free: Koko, Alpro, The Coconut Collaborative, Violife

African foods: Tropical Sun yam, plantain & cassava flours

Sauces: Free & Easy

Shops: Tesco & Sainsbury's Free From, Holland & Barrett, African shops

USA & Canada

Flours: Otto's Naturals cassava flour, Bob's Red Mill gluten-free

Dairy-free: So Delicious, Cocojune, Daiya, Earth's Own

Snacks: Enjoy Life, MadeGood

Shops: Whole Foods, Loblaws (PC Free From), Thrive Market

Healing Lunch Box

BONUS BOOK 1

30 Days of Allergy-Free School Lunches & Snacks Kids Will Actually Eat



30 lunch boxes

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Nut-free

Nut-free and school-safe.

BY

Tris Eliverson

BEFORE YOU START

7 golden lunch box rules

A good lunch box is safe, simple and fun. Follow these 7 golden rules and lunchtime gets easier for everyone.

1. **Pack the night before**
   Mornings are busy. Pack everything except hot food the evening before.

2. **One safe food + one new food**
   Always include a food your child already loves. Put the new food beside it — no pressure.

3. **Keep it cold — or hot**
   Use an ice pack for cold boxes and a thermos for warm food like jollof or soup.

4. **Every box is nut-free**
   Most schools are nut-free. We use sunflower-seed butter instead of peanut butter.

5. **Tell the teacher**
   Give the school a copy of the allergy card from the Printables pack.

6. **Small and colourful wins**
   Small portions, bright colours and fun shapes. Cookie cutters are your best friend.

7. **Let them choose**
   Offer two choices: “Nuggets or pinwheels tomorrow?” Children eat what they choose.

DAY 1 Chicken Nugget Happy Box

Prep the night before

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 homemade chicken nuggets
- [ ] Handful of sweet potato wedges
- [ ] Apple slices + squeeze of lemon
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] 2 tbsp Sunshine Ketchup

STEPS

1. Coat chicken pieces in olive oil, then cassava flour, paprika and salt.
2. Bake with the wedges at 220 °C / 425 °F for 15–18 min.
3. Sunshine Ketchup: simmer 1 cup passata, 2 chopped dates, pinch of salt and a splash of apple cider vinegar for 10 min; blend.
4. Morning: pack everything, ketchup in a little pot for dipping.

Why it helps: A homemade “happy meal” with no egg, no wheat and no added sugar.

Picky eater trick: Cut apple slices with a heart cookie cutter. Shapes make food fun.

DAY 2 Mini Pizza Pinwheels

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread or tortilla
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato passata + pinch oregano
- [ ] 2 tbsp dairy-free cheese, grated
- [ ] A few shreds of cooked chicken
- [ ] Grapes (halved for under-5s)
- [ ] Carrot sticks

STEPS

1. Spread passata over the flatbread. Sprinkle oregano, cheese and chicken.
2. Roll up tightly and slice into 6 rounds.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 8 min — or pack cold.
4. Pack with the grapes and carrots.

Why it helps: All the pizza flavour kids love, in a fun swirl shape.

DAY 3 Rainbow Rice Ball Bento

15 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup cooked short-grain rice
- [ ] ½ cup shredded cooked chicken
- [ ] Pinch of salt
- [ ] Cucumber coins
- [ ] Strawberries & mango cubes
- [ ] Coconut yogurt dip

STEPS

1. Mix the warm rice with chicken and salt.
2. With wet hands, roll into 6 small balls.
3. Pack each food in its own section, sorted by colour.
4. Add the dip in a small pot.

Why it helps: Separate sections are perfect for children who don't like foods touching.

Fun idea: Ask your child to “eat the rainbow” — one bite of every colour.

DAY 4 Turkey & Avocado Roll-Ups

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cassava flatbread or tortilla
- [ ] ½ avocado, mashed
- [ ] 3 slices homemade roast turkey or chicken
- [ ] Lettuce leaf, grated carrot
- [ ] Blueberries
- [ ] Baked plantain chips

STEPS

1. Spread avocado over the flatbread.
2. Layer turkey, lettuce and carrot.
3. Roll tightly and cut into 2-bite pieces.
4. Pack with blueberries and plantain chips.

Why it helps: Homemade meat avoids the nitrates found in most deli slices.

DAY 5 Mini Meatball Skewers

30 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 250 g beef mince
- [ ] 1 flax egg
- [ ] 2 tbsp cassava flour
- [ ] 2 tbsp grated courgette (hidden veg!)
- [ ] ½ tsp garlic powder, salt
- [ ] Cherry tomatoes, cucumber
- [ ] Tomato dip

STEPS

1. Mix mince, flax egg, flour, courgette and seasoning.
2. Roll into 12 small balls.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 15 min. Cool.
4. Thread onto paper straws or blunt picks with halved tomatoes and cucumber.

Why it helps: Food on a stick is fun — and the courgette is hidden inside.

Time saver: Make a double batch and freeze half for next week.

DAY 6 Jollof Rice & Chicken Thermos

Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup leftover jollof rice
- [ ] 3–4 pieces baked chicken
- [ ] Watermelon cubes
- [ ] Carrot sticks

STEPS

1. Heat the jollof and chicken until piping hot in the morning.
2. Fill the thermos with boiling water for 5 min, empty it, then add the food — it stays warm until lunch.
3. Pack the watermelon and carrots separately.

Why it helps: A familiar home favourite makes lunchtime feel safe for sensitive eaters.

DAY 7

DIY “Lunchable” Box

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6 plain rice crackers (check: no corn)
- [ ] 4 slices homemade roast chicken
- [ ] 6 cubes dairy-free cheese
- [ ] Cucumber coins, grapes
- [ ] 2 Sunshine Bliss Balls

STEPS

1. Bliss balls: blitz 1 cup dates, ½ cup sunflower seeds and 2 tbsp coconut; roll into balls.
2. Arrange crackers, chicken, cheese and cucumber in rows.
3. Add grapes and bliss balls.

Why it helps: Kids build their own “cracker stacks” — and feel in charge of their food.

Allergy note: Shop-bought lunch kits contain dairy, wheat and nitrates. This one is clean.

SNACK ATTACK

10 snacks kids can't say no to

Bright, crunchy, dippable and fun. These snacks are made for even the pickiest eaters — all nut-free and free from every food in this book.

1. Veggie Tots

Mash 1 sweet potato with ½ grated courgette and 3 tbsp tapioca flour. Shape into little logs, bake 20 min at 200 °C.

2. Fruit Nachos

Thin apple slices on a plate, drizzled with warm sunflower-seed butter and carob syrup. Sprinkle coconut.

3. Banana Sushi

Spread coconut yogurt on a banana, roll in crushed pumpkin seeds, slice into "sushi" rounds.

4. Frozen Yogurt Bark

Spread coconut yogurt on parchment, dot with berries, freeze 3 hours and snap into pieces.

5. Apple "Donuts"

Slice apples into rings, core them, spread with sunflower-seed butter and add coconut "sprinkles".

6. Baked Plantain Chips

Very thin green plantain slices, olive oil and salt. Bake 15–20 min at 190 °C until crisp.

7. Crunchy Chickpeas

Dry a tin of chickpeas, toss with oil, paprika and salt. Bake 30 min at 200 °C.

8. Sunshine Bliss Balls

Blitz dates, sunflower seeds and coconut. Roll into balls. No nuts, no sugar added.

9. Pancake Skewers

Leftover mini pancakes and strawberries threaded onto paper straws.

10. Cucumber Pizza Coins

Thick cucumber rounds topped with a dab of hummus and chopped tomato.

Carob instead of chocolate

Chocolate and cocoa contain caffeine. Carob tastes chocolatey, is naturally sweet and caffeine-free.

PRINTABLE

Allergy card for school

Print, cut out and give one to the teacher, nanny, grandparents or party host.

MY ALLERGY CARD

My name: _____

I cannot eat: ☐ Gluten (wheat) ☐ Dairy (milk) ☐ Corn ☐ Egg ☐ Caffeine ☐ Tuna ☐ Pork ☐ Nuts

Other: _____

Safe snacks I can have: _____

If I eat something unsafe, please call: _____

Thank you for keeping me safe! ♥

MY ALLERGY CARD

My name: _____

I cannot eat: ☐ Gluten (wheat) ☐ Dairy (milk) ☐ Corn ☐ Egg ☐ Caffeine ☐ Tuna ☐ Pork ☐ Nuts

Other: _____

Safe snacks I can have: _____

If I eat something unsafe, please call: _____

Thank you for keeping me safe! ♥

Healing Sips

BONUS BOOK 2

The 30-Day Gentle Detox & Juicing Plan for the Whole Family



30 detox recipes

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free

One gentle glass a day.

BY

Tris Eliverson

BEFORE YOU START

The gentle way to detox

Detox should be gentle. Our bodies — especially little bodies — clean themselves best when we go slowly and support them every day.

Go slowly

- Children start with ¼–½ cup. Adults, 1 cup.
- One new drink at a time.
- Tummy ache, rash, poor sleep or crankiness? Use less and go slower.

Every day

- Drink plenty of water.
- Add seeds for fibre: chia, flax, pumpkin, sunflower, psyllium.
- Bounce on a trampoline or dance — it moves the lymph system.
- Lemon balm 2 hours before bed for better sleep.

Keep it fresh

- Wash fruit and vegetables well — pesticides are something we reduce.
- Drink juices within 30 minutes of making them.
- Use glass or stainless-steel cups.

Safety first

- No honey for babies under 1 year.
- Ask your doctor before herbs or supplements, especially with medication, pregnancy or breastfeeding.
- Sea moss is rich in iodine — check first if there is a thyroid condition.

Smoothie or juice?

Smoothies keep the fibre — more filling and great for bowels. **Juices** remove the fibre — lighter and quickly absorbed. No juicer? Blend, then strain through a clean cloth or sieve.

DAY 1 The Daily Detox Smoothie

Author's recipe
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 celery stick
- [ ] ½ green apple
- [ ] Handful of blueberries
- [ ] 1 tbsp fresh coriander (cilantro)
- [ ] 1 tbsp fresh parsley
- [ ] 1 cup water (or more)

STEPS

1. Wash everything well.
2. Blend until smooth.
3. Drink fresh, in the morning.

Gentle daily cleanse · Bowels · Hydration · Antioxidants

Why it helps: Celery is the foundation. Apple adds binding fibre. Coriander and parsley are traditional cleansing herbs.

Go slowly: Children: start with half a cup. Detox should be slow and gentle.

DAY 2 Boosted Detox Smoothie

Author's recipe
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Everything from Day 1
- [ ] ¼ tsp spirulina powder
- [ ] ¼ tsp lion's mane powder
- [ ] Brahmi (bacopa) — adults only

STEPS

1. Make the Day 1 smoothie.
2. Add the spirulina and lion's mane.
3. Blend again and drink fresh.

Brain & focus · Mould & yeast support · Energy

Why it helps: Spirulina is rich in iron and protein. Lion's mane is a mushroom traditionally used for focus.

Safety first: Ask your child's doctor before adding any herb or supplement, especially with medication.

DAY 3 Sea Moss & Black Seed Gut Soother

Author's recipe
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tsp sea moss gel (children) or 1 tbsp (adults)
- [ ] 1 ripe banana
- [ ] ½ cup pineapple
- [ ] 1 cup coconut water
- [ ] ½ tsp black seed oil (age 3+, 3 times a week)

STEPS

1. Blend everything until creamy.
2. Drink straight away.
3. Use black seed oil only 3 times a week.

Gut · Skin & eczema · Immunity

Why it helps: Sea moss and black seed oil are the author's go-to pair for gut troubles.

Safety first: Sea moss is rich in iodine. If there's a thyroid condition, ask your doctor first.

DAY 4 Lemon Balm Bedtime Tea

Author's recipe
10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 tbsp dried lemon balm (or 6 fresh leaves)
- [ ] 1 cup hot water
- [ ] Slice of lemon
- [ ] 1 tsp honey (optional — not under age 1)

STEPS

1. Pour hot water over the lemon balm.
2. Cover and steep 5–7 min, then strain.
3. Cool until warm. Add lemon and honey.
4. Drink about 2 hours before bedtime.

Sleep · Calm · Tummy

Why it helps: Lemon balm is the author's favourite herb for sleep — calming and naturally caffeine-free.

DAY 5 Morning Celery Juice

10 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 bunch celery (makes about 1 cup)
- [ ] ½ green apple (optional, for children)

STEPS

1. Wash the celery well and chop.
2. Juice — or blend with ¼ cup water and strain.
3. Drink on an empty stomach, 15–30 min before breakfast.

Digestion · Hydration · Liver support

Why it helps: Celery is the foundation of the author's daily detox.

Go slowly: Children: start with ¼ cup mixed with apple. Build up slowly.

DAY 6 Watermelon Cucumber Cooler

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 2 cups watermelon, cubed
- [ ] ½ cucumber
- [ ] 4 fresh mint leaves
- [ ] Squeeze of lime

STEPS

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Strain if you like it smooth.
3. Serve over ice.

Constipation · Hydration · Kidneys

Why it helps: Watermelon and cucumber are on the author's constipation list — full of water and gentle fibre.

DAY 7

Broccoli Sprout Mango Smoothie

5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Small handful of broccoli sprouts
- [ ] 1 cup mango, fresh or frozen
- [ ] ½ ripe banana
- [ ] 1 cup coconut water
- [ ] Squeeze of lime

STEPS

1. Rinse the sprouts well.
2. Blend everything until smooth.
3. Drink fresh.

Antioxidants | Brain support | Cell repair

Why it helps: Broccoli sprouts are top of the author's greens list. Mango hides the green taste.

Fun idea: Grow your own: soak broccoli seeds in a jar, rinse twice a day — ready in 5 days.